CURRICULUM VITAE

Name

Kenneth Kariuki Waititu

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

A result-oriented medical microbiologist with a strong interest in understanding microbiome in humans, animals and their fluctuations in various health and disease conditions. Committed to unveiling patterns of antimicrobial resistance in commensals and pathogenic bacteria as well as characterization of their resistomes. self-motivated Kenyan with a passion for handling challenges as they emerge and improving delivery of quality of laboratory services. Organized, effective communicator with colleagues and management with possesses ability to remain calm even in stressful or unexpected circumstances. Confident team player, thriving on challenges and with a positive, cheerful attitude to service delivery, clinical laboratory analytical practice and academic study. Adaptable, flexible and willing to learn as well as trustworthy, honest, reliable and looking forward to being part of a team that ensures best possible biomedical research and clinical practice.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

a) **2015 to 2020: Master of Science in Medical Microbiology**
   College: Jomo Kenyatta of Agriculture and Technology
b) **2012-2013: Bachelor of Science in Public Health**
   College: Jomo Kenyatta of Agriculture and Technology
c) **2004 to 2005: Higher Diploma in Medical Laboratory Sciences (Option I: Medical Bacteriology, Mycology, Virology and Immunology)**
   College: Kenya Polytechnic
d) **1998 to 2001: Diploma in Medical laboratory Sciences**
   College: Kenya Polytechnic (Kenya National Examination Council)

CONTINUOUS PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

1. Fertility hormones. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 30-11-2025
2. Benchside clues: modern approaches to diagnosing myeloproliferative neoplasms. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 27-11-2025
3. Resistant *S. aureus* infection, treatment and biosafety measures in healthcare settings. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 24-11-2025

4. Fundamentals of BIORISK management systems. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 21-11-2025
5. Troubleshooting in tissue processing, microtomy and staining. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 19-11-2025
6. Product precision: matching blood components to patient needs. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 18-11-2025
7. Special stains in tissue. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 17-11-2025
8. Assessment of hepatitis in the clinical laboratory. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 15-11-2025
9. Mastering immunohistochemistry techniques. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 14-11-2025
10. Turning paraffin into power: PCR at work in lung cancer detection. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 13-11-2025
11. Rise of superbugs: confronting the global threat of multidrug-resistant organisms (MDROS). LAB MEDICINE SOCIETY OF KENYA. 07-11-2025
12. Disrupting tradition: how non-invasive testing is reshaping haematology. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 30-10-2025
13. AMR surveillance simplified: the laboratory's role. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 21-10-2025
14. Failure mode effect analysis (FMEA): a proactive approach to clinical laboratory quality performance. SMARTPATH DIAGNOSTIC LABORATORY AND WEBINER SERVICES. 08-09-2025
15. Smart blood: leveraging ai for selection & compatibility in immunohematology. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 12-08-2025
16. Bugs and drugs: the MLO's role in antibiotic resistance patterns. MAABARA HUB AFRICA LTD. 31-07-2025

PRESENTATIONS (SELECTED)

a) **Efficacy of *Bidens Pilosa* and *Kalanchoe pinnata* plant extracts on the management of type 2 diabetes in olive baboons.** July 2024. KIPRE Training centre
b) ***Antidiabetic potential of Bidens Pilosa* and *Kalanchoe pinnata* plant extracts in the management of diabetes.** the 2nd Multisectoral Conference on Science Technology and

Innovation being co-hosted by the National Commission for Science Technology and Innovation (NACOSTI), 23rd to 26th May 2023 at Safari Park Hotel, Nairobi.

WORKSHOPS (SELECTED)

PUBLICATIONS AND AWARDS

Publications

1. Kaanto R, Kagira JM, **Waititu K**, Ngotho M, Achoki PH, Gachohi J, et al **(2026)**. Prevalence and antibiotic susceptibility profiles of bacteria isolated from out-patients presenting with septic wounds in Kajiado county, Kenya. Int J Community Med Public Health. 31;13(2):656–62.

2. **Waititu, K**. , Mugo, C. , Nyawira, D. and Mwethera, P. **(2024)** Antidiabetic Properties of *Bidens pilosa* and Its Polyacetylenic Compounds for Management of Diabetes: Systematic Review. *Journal of Biosciences and Medicines*, **12**, 164-179.

3. Michira, L., Kagira, J., Maina, N., **Waititu, K**., Kiboi, D., Ongera, E., & Ngotho, M. **(2023)**. Prevalence of subclinical mastitis, associated risk factors and antimicrobial susceptibility pattern of bacteria isolated from milk of dairy cattle in Kajiado Central sub-county, Kenya. *Veterinary Medicine and Science*, 9(6): 2885–2892.

4. Ong'era, E., Kagira, J., Maina, N., Kiboi, D., **Waititu, K**., Michira, L., & Ngotho, M. **(2023)**. Prevalence and Potential Risk Factors for the Acquisition of Antibiotic-Resistant *Staphylococcus* spp. Bacteria Among Pastoralist Farmers in Kajiado Central Subcounty, Kenya. *BioMed Research International*, *2023*, e3573056.

5. Otenga FO, Kagira JM, **Waititu K**, Kiboi DM, Ngotho M, & Maina N. **(2022)**. Prevalence, risk factors and antibiogram of bacteria isolated from skin of human having close contact with dairy cows in small-holder farms in Gatundu Sub-County, Kenya. *International Journal of Community Medicine and Public Health*, *9*(11), 4039–4045.

6. **Waititu K,** Ngetich R, & Obiero J. **(2022)**. Molecular Characterisation of Diarrhoeagenic *Escherichia coli* Isolated from Captive and Free-Ranging Olive Baboons (*Papio anubis*) Faecal Samples. European Medical Journal. http://emj.emg-health.com/microbiology-infectious-diseases/article/molecular-characterisation-of-diarrhoeagenic-escherichia-coli-isolated-from-captive-and-free-ranging-olive-baboons-papio-anubis-faecal-samples/

7. Kaanto, R., Kagira, J, **Waititu, K,** Ngotho, M., Maina, N., & Gachohi, J. **(2021)**. Characteristics of patients presenting with septic wounds in selected hospitals in Kajiado County, Kenya. *International Journal of Community Medicine and Public Health*, *8*(8), 3743–3749.

8. Nkatha ML, Kangogo M, **Waititu KK** & Sang WK. **(2021)**. Characterization of Selected Escherichia coli Pathovars and Their Antimicrobial Resistance Patterns among Diarrheal Children under the Age of Five Years from Machakos County, Kenya. *American Journal of Infectious Diseases and Microbiology*, *9*(2), 51–55.

9. **Waititu, K.,** Jerono, C., Kituku, D., Nzuve, M., Mambo, F., Ngugi, P., & Mwethera, P. **(2018)**. Phytochemical Composition of Kalanchoe pinnata and Bidens pilosa Leaves Associated with Management of Diabetes. *Biomedicine and Biotechnology*, *6*(1).

10. **Waititu KK**, Nyerere KA, Samuel K. & Apondi, OJ. **(2018).** Antimicrobial Susceptibility Patterns of *Escherichia coli* Isolated from Olive Baboon (*Papio anubis*) Gut. *American Journal of Infectious Diseases and Microbiology*, *6*(2), 38–45.

11. Lugano SD, Nyerere KA, **Waititu KK**, Samuel K, Joseph K and Apondi OJ. **(2018).** Gastrointestinal Microbial Flora in Wild and Captive Olive Baboons (*Papio anubis*). *American Journal of Infectious Diseases and Microbiology*, 6(1); 30–37

12. Obiero JA, **Waititu KK,** Mulei I, Omar FI, Jaoko W & Mwethera PG. **(2016).** Baboon vaginal microbial flora. *Journal of Medical Primatology*, *45*(3); 147–155.

13. Obanda V, Poghon J, Yongo M, Mulei I, Ngotho M, **Waititu KK**, Makumi J, Gakuya F, Omondi P, Soriguer RC, Alasaad S. **(2013)**. First reported case of fatal tuberculosis in a wild African elephant with past human-wildlife contact. *Epidemiology and Infection*, *141*(7), 1476–1480.

14. Jael AO, Robert K, **Waititu KK**, Isaac M, Idle OF, Kavoo L, Walter J, Peter GM. **(2013).** A Comparative Study of Smugel and KY Jelly Vaginal Lubricating Gels. *Journal of Reproduction and Contraception 24* (2), 76–87.

15. Kagira JM, Oluoch G, **Waititu, KK,** Mulei I, Maingi N, Ngotho M. **(2011).** High Efficacy of Combined Albendazole and Ivermectin Treatment against Gastrointestinal Nematodes in Vervet Monkeys and Baboons. *Scandinavian Journal of Laboratory Animal Science*, *38*(3); 187–193.

16. Mburu N, Obiero JA, **Waititu KK**, Mwaura BN, Orawo JO, Farah IO, Mwethera PG. **(2009)**. Safety studies of a recently developed microbicidal contraceptive gel (UniPron) in female baboons (*Papio anubis*). *African Journal of Reproductive Health*, *13*(4); 95–104.

17. Obiero JA., Mburu MN, Ndung'u BM, **Waititu KK**, Mulei I, Farah IO & Mwethera P. **(2008).** UniPron is A Fully Effective Non-Hormonal Reversible Contraceptive in Baboon Model (*Papio anubis*). *Journal of Reproduction and Contraception*, *19* (2); 107–118.

18. Muoria PK, Muruthi P, **Waititu KK**, Boru AH, Mijele D and Oguge NO. **(2007).** Anthrax outbreak among Grevy's zebra (*Equus grevyi*) in Samburu, Kenya. *African Journal of Ecology*, *45*(4); 483-489.

Awards

LAST DATE PROMOTED

28/11/2016 – Senior laboratory technologist I (NM 7)

REFERENCES

1. Dr. Mercy Akinyi
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   Kenya Institute of Primate Research,
   P.O. Box 24481, Karen
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2. Dr. Jael Obiero,
   Head of Department,
   Department of Reproductive and Health Biology
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3. Dr. Danson Mwangi
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Signature_____ _____

Date_____23-04-2026_____